



MENTEE

GUIDEBOOK



Program Overview



How to Get Involved

Sign up as a student mentee on our website or Scan the QR code to sign up.

The AGORA Mentorship Program is a student-led initiative run by VSEUS that connects students in the VSE network to provide valuable academic and career insights.

AGORA Mentorship helps lower-year mentees learn from upper-year students who have already navigated many of the same academic and extracurricular challenges. The program also connects upper-year mentees with VSE alumni mentors to offer valuable exposure to life after graduation.

Why become a mentee?

You can gain valuable skills and guidance from your mentor. This could be job-search strategies, academic advice, building interview skills, and more!

If you encounter any issues or need any support throughout the program, please feel free to email us at academic@vseus.ca.

About VSEUS

Mission

The Vancouver School of Economics Undergraduate Society (VSEUS) represents **1000+ Economics students** at the University of British Columbia (UBC). VSEUS is UBC's newest undergraduate society, representing students of the #1 Economics school in the country. VSEUS ensures that undergraduate Economics students have access to the support and resources they need throughout their academic career at UBC.

Values

1. **Academic Success:** Supporting academic pursuits and creating opportunities to connect with professors.
2. **Student Advocacy:** Representing the interests of students to governing bodies.
3. **Career Preparedness:** Connecting students with industry professionals and building workplace readiness.
4. **Community Engagement:** Raising school spirit and creating environments where students feel connected and welcomed.

Program Structure

The Agora Mentorship Program pairs experienced alumni and/or upper-year mentors based on shared career, academic, and personal interests. The goal is to create pairings in which mentees can receive relevant guidance from someone whose experiences, knowledge, or career paths align with what they hope to learn about.

The mentorship program will run from October to December. Meetings may take place in person or virtually, depending on what is most convenient for both the mentor and the mentee. Meetings may focus on academic planning, career exploration, networking, or any other areas in which you would appreciate more guidance.

Mentee Responsibilities

- Mentees are responsible for initiating and maintaining contact with their mentor and arranging meetings throughout the program.
- Mentees must meet with their mentors at least once a month (with the possibility of extra meetings if mutually agreed upon).
- Take an active role in the mentorship; be prepared, ask questions and apply what you learn!
- Be flexible when coordinating around your mentor's availability.

Tip:

When first contacting your mentor, consider sending them a copy of your resume!

Milestones and Suggested Dates

Milestones	Suggested Date
1 - Initiate Connection Mentee sends an introductory email to their mentor and pairs set up their first meeting time.	October 5th
2 - Planting Seeds for Success Participate in the first mentorship meeting and set meeting dates/times for the rest of the program.	October 12th
3 - Budding Connections Participate in the second mentorship meeting.	November 2nd
4 - In Full Bloom Participate in the third mentorship meeting	November 23rd
5 - Reflect and Learn Mentee reflects on lessons learned. Mentor and Mentee complete and submit the feedback survey.	December 7th

You are responsible for sending the first email and maintaining contact with your mentor. Please consider the following email template to initiate contact:

Subject: Introduction and Meeting Request

Hello **[Mentor's Name]**,

My name is **[Your Name]**, and I am delighted to have been matched with you as your mentee through the Agora Mentorship Program. I am a **[insert degree and year]** student.

I greatly appreciate your commitment to mentoring, and I look forward to learning from your experience and gaining guidance as I work towards my academic and professional goals.

To kick off our mentorship journey, could we schedule our first meeting within the next two weeks? I'm open to meeting either in-person or online, depending on your preference. Here are a few time slots that work for me:

- **[Insert First Availability]**
- **[Insert Second Availability]**
- **[Insert Third Availability]**

Please let me know which option suits you best, or propose alternative dates if needed.

Looking forward to our initial discussion!

Best regards,
[Your Name]

**Email
Template**

Sample Discussion Questions

- How do you achieve a balance between your personal and professional life? What methods have been most effective for you?
- What was your biggest challenge within the VSE? How did you overcome it?
- Are there particular courses, professors, or experiences at the VSE that had a notable impact on you?
- What tips do you have for creating a standout resume?
- How would you go about networking with professionals and finding internships for the summer?
- What skills or certifications would you recommend for someone aiming to excel in your field?
- Looking back on your academic journey and/or career, are there any decisions or actions you would change if given another chance?

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q: What if I missed the sign-up deadline?

A: We cannot accommodate late sign-ups. However, you are also welcome to join the next round of mentorship in the second semester.

Q: Will I be guaranteed a match in my top chosen industry if I participate?

A: No, but we will try. Your likelihood of being matched to a mentor in a given industry depends on mentor demand and availability.

Q: How are matches made?

Matches are made based on academic, personal, and career alignment.

Q: What if I'm matched with someone but don't hear from them?

A: The responsibility to reach out lies with the mentee. If you haven't heard from them for 1 week, feel free to send a follow-up email or email us at academic@vseus.ca.

Q: What happens when the program concludes?

A: At the end of the program, mentors and mentees will be encouraged to fill out our feedback survey, but you are welcome to maintain contact with your mentor even after the program ends.

Q: Is it possible to have more or fewer than three meetings?

A: The program sets a minimum of three meetings. However, you are welcome to schedule additional meetings if mutually agreed upon.

**Thank you for participating in the
2026/27 AGORA Mentorship Program!**

